

. Intro to Stata

A two-hour hands-on session

University of Groningen

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Friday 11 September 2026 · 11:00–13:00

`github.com/febriady/intro-to-stata`

. Does a year of school raise your wage?

8,000 simulated wage workers

shaped on a real Indonesian survey from 2014, the one behind the paper you will meet at the end. today you put the question to the data yourself

(you are betting a degree's worth of tuition that the answer is yes)

- **Stata's first answer: no**

-0.0003

`corr(wage, schooling)`, the laziest question you can ask these data

*the data contain ordinary errors; the mistake is computing before looking.
by 13:00 you will have looked, and answered the question properly*

- **By 13:00 you will have run every step of a real analysis**

set up → look → clean → build → estimate

not a tour of menus; one dataset, interrogated start to finish,
the same arc as every empirical paper you will read this year

. The university gives you Stata two ways

`uwp.rug.nl`

the university's virtual workplace.
sign in with your student account

IRIS

download and install it
on your own machine, for later

any Stata from 14 (2015) onward runs everything today.
the session files check your setup for you

. Stata is four windows and one editor



the four windows are Stata talking to you; the editor is you talking back

- You write the do-file; Stata writes the log**



keep both; next week's you can re-read today

. Everything you just downloaded

together, today

`README.md` — setup steps + the troubleshooting table

together, today

`code/` — five do-files (00–04); you run every command in them today

together, today

`data/simulated/` — the dataset; simulated, ships in the ZIP

on your own

`exercises/` — three exercises; the first begun together in class

on your own

`extensions/` — five add-on modules, from loops to project structure

on your own

`docs/` — the esttab recipe, for your first table

solid tag: hands-on, together, in the next two hours.
outlined tag: the same style of practice, at your own pace

- **One command tells you whether your setup works**

unzip the download, point Stata at the folder that contains `README.md`, then type:

```
do "code/00_smoke_test.do"
```

SMOKE TEST PASSED

if you see that, sit back. if you see an error, read it out loud and we will fix it together

• segment 2

First, look.

use describe summarize tabulate browse
histogram scatter correlate

25 minutes

. segment 3

Missing is the largest number Stata knows.

```
count list replace drop  
if schooling > 12 & !missing(schooling)
```

20 minutes

. Your turn

How many respondents have
9 or more years of schooling?

count it the naive way, then correctly

three minutes, alone. solutions stay closed.
we compare answers before the next segment

when your two counts differ, be ready to say by how many, and why

• segment 4

Build the variables the question needs.

```
generate  replace  egen  
label variable  label define  label values
```

15 minutes

. segment 5

Settle the score.

correlate regress predict

-0.0003 → 0.3412 → 0.3920

raw errors deleted in logs

25 minutes

. You just reproduced the OLS benchmark of a real paper



Febriady, Postępska & Angelini (2026), GLO Discussion Paper 1731.

OLS, not causal — schooling is chosen, not assigned. [extensions/module_C](#) shows what that hides.

. The repo is yours

`github.com/febriady/intro-to-stata`

download it again any time; everything re-runs from one fixed seed.
if your numbers differ, something is wrong, and that is the point

cheat sheets to keep open while you work:

`geocenter.github.io/StataTraining`

- **Every step was code —**

which means every step can be rerun, checked, and improved by someone who was not in this room.

$-0.0003 \rightarrow 0.3920$